

STAGE TWO • PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY & PERSONAL BRAND

# FIRSTS

---

## SESSION PLAN

*Six sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 40 FIRSTS as a live workshop*

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

# FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Two • Professional Identity & Personal Brand

## OVERVIEW

Stage Two's forty FIRSTS are split across six sessions, one per section, matching the Manual's existing structure: Personal Professional Identity, Personal Brand Foundations, Digital Presence & Online Identity, Professional Communication, Professional Visibility, and Professional Materials. This is double Stage One's session count, reflecting Stage Two's larger scope.

Several sessions in this stage (3, 4, and parts of 6) involve genuine hands-on building — editing a live LinkedIn profile, building a website, setting up an email signature — not just reflection. Confirm participants have their actual accounts and devices accessible, not just the Templates workbook.

## AT A GLANCE

| Time      | Segment                                      | Format   |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------|----------|
| Session 1 | Personal Professional Identity — B1-B6       | ~115 min |
| Session 2 | Personal Brand Foundations — B7-B12          | ~110 min |
| Session 3 | Digital Presence & Online Identity — B13-B20 | ~140 min |
| Session 4 | Professional Communication — B21-B27         | ~115 min |
| Session 5 | Professional Visibility — B28-B34            | ~110 min |
| Session 6 | Professional Materials — B35-B40             | ~100 min |

## SESSION 1

### Personal Professional Identity

*Covers FIRSTS B1-B6: Professional Introduction, Elevator Pitch, Personal Brand Statement, Professional Communication Style, Professional Confidence Mindset, Personal Value Statement.*

## PRE-WORK

- No advance preparation required. Ask participants to bring a recent, real email they've sent (school or work) to reference during FIRST 04.

## SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                         | Format                          |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 0:00-0:10 | Welcome + why personal brand starts with how you introduce yourself, not a logo | Full group                      |
| 0:10-0:30 | FIRST B1 — Professional Introduction: framing + draft + record                  | Solo, then pairs practice aloud |
| 0:30-0:55 | FIRST B2 — Elevator Pitch: two versions, practiced aloud                        | Solo, then pairs                |

|           |                                                                    |                                              |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 0:55-1:15 | FIRST B3 — Personal Brand Statement + stranger paraphrase test     | Solo, then pairs                             |
| 1:15-1:20 | Short break                                                        | —                                            |
| 1:20-1:40 | FIRST B4 — Professional Communication Style: rewrite 3 real emails | Solo                                         |
| 1:40-1:55 | FIRST B5 — Professional Confidence Mindset                         | Solo                                         |
| 1:55-2:15 | FIRST B6 — Personal Value Statement + session close                | Solo, then full-group share of one statement |

#### FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRSTS B1, B2, and B3 all benefit from being said out loud, not just written — build pair practice into each rather than saving it for the end.
- If running long, B5 (Confidence Mindset) can compress to a quick framing plus individual commitment, without a full group discussion.

## SESSION 2

# Personal Brand Foundations

*Covers FIRSTS B7–B12: Personal Brand Strategy, Personal Brand Positioning, Professional Reputation Awareness, Professional Image Audit, Credibility Signals, Professional Boundaries.*

### PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one trusted person (peer, mentor, colleague) they could genuinely ask for honest reputation feedback (FIRST B9) this week.

### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                                              | Format                                  |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + bridge: yesterday was how you present yourself, today is the deliberate strategy behind it | Full group                              |
| 0:10–0:30 | FIRST B7 — Personal Brand Strategy: 3 words + reinforcing actions                                    | Solo                                    |
| 0:30–0:50 | FIRST B8 — Personal Brand Positioning + stranger test                                                | Solo, then pairs                        |
| 0:50–1:05 | FIRST B9 — Professional Reputation Awareness: framing + plan who to ask                              | Solo (actual ask happens after session) |
| 1:05–1:10 | Short break                                                                                          | —                                       |
| 1:10–1:30 | FIRST B10 — Professional Image Audit: compare against 3 real LinkedIn profiles                       | Solo, laptops needed                    |
| 1:30–1:45 | FIRST B11 — Credibility Signals: identify 3 real upcoming commitments                                | Solo                                    |
| 1:45–2:05 | FIRST B12 — Professional Boundaries + session close                                                  | Solo, then optional pair share          |

### FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST B9 can't be completed live — it requires asking a real person outside the session. Frame it as launched today, followed up on at the next session's opening.
- FIRST B10 needs internet access; have 2–3 backup profile examples ready per common target field in case someone can't find their own comparisons quickly.

## SESSION 3

# Digital Presence & Online Identity

*Covers FIRSTS B13–B20: LinkedIn Profile, LinkedIn Headline Strategy, Professional Bio, Digital Footprint Audit, Personal Website, Professional Portfolio, Professional Headshot, Branding Color Scheme & Logo (Optional).*

### PRE-WORK

- Confirm every participant has LinkedIn account access and, ideally, a laptop rather than only a phone — this session is the most hands-on build session in the stage.
- For FIRST B19, suggest participants wear something they'd genuinely want in a professional headshot.

### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                  | Format                           |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + framing: this session is hands-on building, not just planning  | Full group                       |
| 0:10–0:35 | FIRST B13 — LinkedIn Profile: live editing of one blank/outdated section | Solo, laptops required           |
| 0:35–0:50 | FIRST B14 — LinkedIn Headline Strategy: live rewrite                     | Solo                             |
| 0:50–1:05 | FIRST B15 — Professional Bio: 3-sentence draft                           | Solo                             |
| 1:05–1:10 | Short break                                                              | —                                |
| 1:10–1:25 | FIRST B16 — Digital Footprint Audit: incognito self-search               | Solo                             |
| 1:25–1:50 | FIRST B17 — Personal Website: build a live homepage                      | Solo, laptops required           |
| 1:50–2:10 | FIRST B18 — Professional Portfolio: 4-sentence case study                | Solo                             |
| 2:10–2:30 | FIRST B19 — Professional Headshot: take + select photos                  | Solo, phones needed              |
| 2:30–2:40 | FIRST B20 — Branding Color Scheme (Optional) + close                     | Solo, skip for non-visual fields |

### FACILITATOR NOTES

- This is the longest session in the stage by design — consider splitting it across two shorter meetings if your cohort's attention flags past two hours.
- FIRST B20 is explicitly optional; don't let it eat into time needed for B13–B19, which apply to every participant regardless of field.
- Have a designated well-lit spot in the room (or a note to use a window) ready before B19 begins, so headshot time doesn't stall on logistics.

## SESSION 4

# Professional Communication

*Covers FIRSTS B21–B27: Professional Email Style, Professional Email Template, Meeting Presence, Question-Asking Skill, Professional Listening Skill, Public Speaking Recording, Video Introduction.*

### PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to have a recent real email accessible to rewrite during FIRST B21, and to bring their phone for two recording exercises later in this session.

### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                                            | Format              |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + framing: brand is also how you communicate day to day, not just how you present yourself | Full group          |
| 0:10–0:25 | FIRST B21 — Professional Email Style: live rewrite of a real email                                 | Solo                |
| 0:25–0:40 | FIRST B22 — Professional Email Template: draft one reusable template                               | Solo                |
| 0:40–0:55 | FIRST B23 — Meeting Presence: prep one contribution point                                          | Solo                |
| 0:55–1:00 | Short break                                                                                        | —                   |
| 1:00–1:15 | FIRST B24 — Question-Asking Skill: prep two questions                                              | Solo                |
| 1:15–1:30 | FIRST B25 — Professional Listening Skill: paraphrase practice                                      | Pairs               |
| 1:30–1:50 | FIRST B26 — Public Speaking Recording: record + review the B2 pitch                                | Solo, phones needed |
| 1:50–2:10 | FIRST B27 — Video Introduction: record 60-second video + close                                     | Solo, phones needed |

### FACILITATOR NOTES

- B26 and B27 both involve on-camera recording and reviewing — acknowledge upfront that this feels awkward for almost everyone, which lowers the room's guard.
- B25 is the one FIRST in this session that requires a partner; pair people up deliberately rather than leaving it to chance.

## SESSION 5

### Professional Visibility

*Covers FIRSTS B28–B34: Thoughtful Social Media Presence, LinkedIn Post Engagement, Professional Content Share, Blog/Article Post, Thought Leadership Series, Industry Trend Report, Professional Conversation Starter.*

#### PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring to mind (or bookmark) one article or post from the past month that genuinely interested them professionally, for use in FIRST B29 and B30.

#### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                 | Format                                    |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + framing: visibility is a practice, not a single post          | Full group                                |
| 0:10–0:25 | FIRST B28 — Thoughtful Social Media Presence: set one weekly commitment | Solo                                      |
| 0:25–0:40 | FIRST B29 — LinkedIn Post Engagement: follow 5, draft 1 comment         | Solo, laptops needed                      |
| 0:40–0:55 | FIRST B30 — Professional Content Share: draft a share + commentary      | Solo                                      |
| 0:55–1:00 | Short break                                                             | —                                         |
| 1:00–1:20 | FIRST B31 — Blog/Article Post: outline a 500-word post                  | Solo                                      |
| 1:20–1:40 | FIRST B32 — Thought Leadership Series: outline 3–5 future topics        | Solo                                      |
| 1:40–2:00 | FIRST B33 — Industry Trend Report: identify a trend + 2 sources         | Solo, laptops needed                      |
| 2:00–2:10 | FIRST B34 — Professional Conversation Starter + close                   | Solo, then full-group share of one opener |

#### FACILITATOR NOTES

- B31 and B32 are closely linked; if time is tight, treat B32 as a five-minute extension of B31 rather than a fully separate block.
- Closing with B34's full-group share works well since each opener is short — this also doubles as real practice hearing openers out loud.

## SESSION 6

### Professional Materials

*Covers FIRSTS B35–B40: Resume That Stands Out, Cover Letter That Works, Business Card / Email Signature, Portfolio/Project Showcase, Online Portfolio Review, Digital Presence Plan.*

#### PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring their current resume and one real job listing they're genuinely interested in, for use in FIRSTS B35 and B36.

#### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                                     | Format                          |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + framing: today turns everything from this stage into finished, tangible materials | Full group                      |
| 0:10–0:30 | FIRST B35 — Resume That Stands Out: rewrite 2 bullets against a real listing                | Solo                            |
| 0:30–0:50 | FIRST B36 — Cover Letter That Works: draft an opening line                                  | Solo                            |
| 0:50–1:00 | FIRST B37 — Business Card / Email Signature: live setup                                     | Solo, hands-on                  |
| 1:00–1:05 | Short break                                                                                 | —                               |
| 1:05–1:20 | FIRST B38 — Portfolio/Project Showcase: 2-minute spoken walkthrough                         | Solo, then pairs practice aloud |
| 1:20–1:35 | FIRST B39 — Online Portfolio Review: draft + send a real request                            | Solo                            |
| 1:35–1:55 | FIRST B40 — Digital Presence Plan: cross-check all platforms + stage close                  | Solo, then full-group close     |

#### FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST B40 is the capstone of the entire stage, not just this session — give it genuine room rather than rushing it if earlier segments ran long.
- Close the full stage by having each participant name one specific inconsistency they found and fixed during B40 — concrete, not aspirational.
- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Three (Job Application & Interview Skills), which directly builds on the resume, portfolio, and materials finished today.